

WANG ZHAODONG

Pronounced roughly: Wong Jow-dong

Design Researcher
Master's Candidate in Design

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Design researcher investigating and reimagining social relations in shared environments through discursive design, embodied inquiry and technological mediation.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Public Space and Social Relations;
Discursive and Speculative Design;
Embodied Experience and Meaning-Making;
Human-Technology Relations and Design Methodology

RESEARCH CAPABILITIES

First-Person / Qualitative Inquiry
Conceptual & Relational Modelling
Empirical-to-Design Translation
Metaphor/Schema Analysis • XR Prototyping

PUBLICATIONS & MANUSCRIPTS

Z. Wang, & F. You (2026). From Subtle Embodied Social Experience to Designable Relations: An Image-Schema-Mediated Empirical-to-Design Method

First author • Under review at ACM CHI 2027 • Preprint available on SSRN
doi:10.2139/ssrn.7201181

F. You, X. Yan, Z. Wang, & Q. Fu (2026). Seeing the whole process: How cooperative process transparency in AR-HMI affects driver cognition in V2V lane changes.

Corresponding author • Transportation Research Part F: Traffic Psychology and Behaviour, 123, 103830.
doi:10.1016/j.trf.2026.103830

Y. Chen, F. Jia, Z. Wang, J. Zhang, F. You, & J. Wang (2026). Designing multimodal takeover request interfaces: The impact of warning modalities and information types on drivers' takeover performance and subjective perception.

Co-author • Under review at Transportation Research Part F: Traffic Psychology and Behaviour

Y. Chen, Y. Jin, F. Jia, J. Wang, Z. Wang, B. Mehler, & F. You (2026). Beyond attention reminders: Effects of monitoring request design type and non-driving-related task engagement on driver takeover performance and subjective perceptions.

Co-author • Under review at Accident Analysis & Prevention

Y. Chen, J. Wang, F. Jia, X. Wu, Q. Xiao, Z. Wang, & F. You (2025). Is control necessary for drivers? Exploring the influence of human-machine collaboration modes on driving behavior and subjective perception under different hazard visibility scenarios.

Co-author • Accident Analysis & Prevention, 217, 108067. doi:10.1016/j.aap.2025.108067

EDUCATION

9/2024 - 6/2027 M.A. in Design Tongji University, Shanghai, China
Working thesis title: Mixed-Reality Interaction Design for Public-Space Social Experience
GPA: 4.76/5.0 • Supervisor: Professor Fang You, FRSA
Selected coursework: User Research 98/100; Narrative Studies 90/100; Service Design 96/100.

9/2020 - 6/2024 B.Sc. in Physics Jilin University, Changchun, China
Selected coursework: Computational Physics A 96/100; Mechanics 93/100; C Programming 92/100.

SELECTED RESEARCH PROJECTS

2025–Present XR Design for Subtle Embodied Social Experience Master's Thesis Researcher, Tongji University

- **Social and design proposition:** Used gaze as a case of subtle embodied experience to reimagine relations among strangers in public space, proposing XR imagery as an interaction mediator and discursive medium for alternative forms of public sociality.
- **Experiential modelling:** To determine what such imagery should represent, used conceptual metaphor and image-schema theories to model how gaze enters experience, acquires embodied/metaphorical meaning and informs action; distinguished substrate-level from meaning-construal affordances.
- **First-person inquiry:** To ground this model in lived experience, combined episode-focused first-person inquiry with a dual-track analysis of fleeting gaze episodes, separating problem-defining perceptual conditions from relation-providing conceptual-metaphorical relations.
- **Empirical-to-design translation:** To make open-ended experiential material operable in design, developed an image-schema-mediated method structuring it as a constrained relational design space, preserving empirical grounding while allowing designer judgment and multiple defensible forms.
- **Design case and implementation:** Applied the process with 16 participants (782 interview minutes; 160,162 Chinese transcript characters), deriving a relational grammar and three XR concepts; selected Membrane-Bubble and currently implementing it in Unity XR for laboratory evaluation.

2025 - Present	Cooperative Process Transparency in AR-HMI Examines how different levels of cooperative process transparency affect driver cognition during Vehicle-to-Vehicle (V2V) cooperative lane changes. - Contributed to the conceptualization and three-level operationalization of cooperative process transparency; curated and formally analysed performance and subjective data. - Produced research visualizations and led manuscript preparation and revision.	Co-Researcher, Tongji University
2024 - 2025	AR Social-Space Design through Interpersonal Distance and Social Cues Examines how virtual-agent layout, gesture amplitude, and interaction guidance shape affect, social presence, and continued engagement in AR. - Contributed to research conceptualization and curated and formally analysed the experimental data. - Drafted the original manuscript and contributed to its review and revision.	Co-Researcher, Tongji University
2024 - Present	Automated-Driving HMI and Driver Attention Comprises three driving-simulator studies of collaboration modes, monitoring requests, and multimodal takeover warnings. - Contributed to the design and execution of one controlled driving-simulator study; processed and analysed eye-tracking and fNIRS data across the project studies. - Contributed to the interpretation of results and manuscript review and revision.	Co-Researcher, Tongji University

SELECTED DESIGN & SPATIAL PRACTICE

2023–Present	ExpoCraft – Reconstruction of Expo 2010 Shanghai Reconstruct Expo 2010 Shanghai in Minecraft from maps, photographs and archival records; translate fragmented sources into a navigable spatial archive.	Independent Designer • Ongoing Project
2025	The Field of Seeds – Physical-Computing Installation Developed the concept, analysed the site and designed interactions/circuitry; co-built a wind/proximity-responsive Arduino prototype inspired by the UK Pavilion (Seed Cathedral) at Expo 2010 Shanghai.	Co-Designer • Course Project
2025	Rooftop Garden – Site-Specific Interactive Projection Designed a projection proposal for a typhoon-displaced roof: passersby’s silhouettes trigger projected flowers, linking interaction with architectural memory.	Independent Designer • Course Proposal
2024	Minetrarchi – Minecraft-Based Architectural Learning Game Designed the concept, art, game mechanics and interactions for a Minecraft-based game concept teaching traditional Chinese timber architecture through guided tasks and free building.	Co-Designer • Design Concept

EXTERNAL RESEARCH COLLABORATIONS

2025	Eye-Tracking Experiment and Analysis Coordinator Provided methodological training and supervised eye-tracking experiments and data analysis for an industry collaboration on task complexity in cloud change operations.	Tongji University & Huawei Technologies Co., Ltd.
2025–2026	EEG Data Analysis Coordinator Supervised and conducted EEG data analysis for the project “Cognitive and Neural Mechanisms Underlying the Detection and Dissemination of AI-Generated Misinformation.”	Beijing Institute of Petrochemical Technology

LEADERSHIP & CULTURAL ENGAGEMENT

2020–2023	Photojournalist; Co-Deputy Head & Head of Photography Led photographic reporting for campus news, cultural events and public communication.	Jilin University Press Corps
2020–2024	Deputy Head Led college online communications and media presence; co-organised campus activities.	New Media Department, Physics Student Union, Jilin University
2020–2022	Changchun Architectural Heritage Documentation Studied Changchun’s Japanese-colonial (Manchukuo-era) architecture through public history writing and field photography; advocated preservation. Individual articles reached 10,000+ reads and 100+ saves.	Independent Researcher / Writer / Photographer

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Experimental Methods	Driving Simulation • Eye Tracking • EEG/fNIRS Analysis
Research • Analysis	SPSS • MATLAB • GraphPad Prism • NVivo • Tobii Pro Lab
Programming • XR	Unity • Python • C/C++
Design • Media	Figma • Adobe Photoshop • Adobe Premiere Pro • Blender • SketchUp
Authoring	LaTeX

LANGUAGES

Chinese - Native, English - Academic working proficiency, Japanese - Intermediate, French - Elementary